



The 3-2-1 rule of backup

It works wonders, so give it a try

Just because your files appear on your phone, laptop, cloud drive, and maybe even your tablet does not mean they are properly protected. It just means they are conveniently available. It's useful, but ultimately not enough.

The backup rule that has survived years of hardware failures, accidental deletions, corrupted drives, ransomware attacks, and human overconfidence is the classic 3-2-1 rule: keep three copies of important data, on two different kinds of media, with one copy off-site. NIST still recommends exactly this approach in its ransomware and data-loss guidance, while CISA continues to

advise offline, encrypted backups and regular testing of whether those backups can actually be restored.

Don't be confused, the 3-2-1 rule isn't meant only for IT people. It is really a way of forcing you to stop trusting one device, one account, or one storage habit with the pieces of your life that matter most. Let us decode it properly.

What "3" really means

The first number is three copies of your important data. One is your original working copy. The other two are backups. So if you are editing photos on your laptop, the laptop is not one